inherently deserves protection. These questions have played out not only in philosophical arenas, but also in the legal and political spheres.

In 1969, the Sierra Club, an environmental lobbying group, challenged a US Forest Service permit allowing Walt Disney Enterprises to survey the Mineral King Valley in California—Disney wanted to build a ski resort there. The Valley had no official protected designation beyond that of a game refuge, but the Sierra Club argued that the area should be preserved in its original state for its own sake. The suit went to the Supreme Court, which in 1974 ruled in favor of the Forest Service and Disney. By then, however, Disney's interest had waned; today the Valley is part of Sequoia National Park.

The battle between those who follow anthropocentric ethics and those who argue for ecocentric approaches has continued. It often takes place in political arenas, particularly with the increased prominence of globally sensitive issues such as climate change. Sustainable development has generally been an anthropocentric endeavor, to ensure future generations have their needs met. Environmental ethicists tend to argue that sustainability is only viable if it preserves the future of all members of the ecosystem.